

# The Numbers Were Revised Overnight

*Two of Saturday's figures were wrong by Sunday morning, and nothing in the world happened in between.*

## THE READING

The S&P 500 settled Friday at 7,489.72, up 0.70%, forty-eight points beneath Hedgeye's 7,538 ceiling. The ten-year yield closed at 4.745%, up 8.2 basis points and through a 4.71% ceiling lowered that same morning; the thirty-year reached 5.28%, a nineteen-year high. The VIX fell to 15.99, a fifth of a point above the floor of its band, on the morning its signal was downgraded to bearish. The tape is calm.

Then the settles arrived. Saturday's brief carried WTI at \$86.80, up 3.84%; the settled mark is \$84.67, up 1.29%. It carried copper up 0.51%; copper fell 0.14%. That sign flip removes the only metal that rose on Friday — every metal fell. Markets are shut. Nothing happened over the weekend to cause any of it. The record changed, not the world.

## WHAT WISDOM WOULD SAY

Montaigne, in the essay "Of Cripples," watched how a report thickens as it travels — each retelling adding a detail nobody witnessed, until a conclusion heavy enough to have someone burned rests on testimony no one has checked. That, he thought, was a very high price to put on one's own conjectures. His motto was a question: *Que sais-je?* What do I know?

The application here is narrow. Saturday's brief built a paragraph on a five per cent intraday reversal in crude. The reversal was real, and wider than described — the range was 7.2% — but the settle gave back \$2.20, and the sentence you write off \$86.80 is not the sentence you write off \$84.67. Copper was worse, because it was not a decimal but a claim: the exception that rose became no exception at all.

Nothing was invented. A quote was captured at 16:59 and the settlement came later. That is how most wrong things are wrong. Not fabricated — early.

## THE RISK IT JUSTIFIES

Before Monday's open, separate what you know from what you were told at one moment on Friday afternoon. Go through the positions whose case rests on a single number from a single capture, and check that number against a settled source before sizing anything on it.

Anything derived from Friday's crude spike deserves the smaller size — the refiner divergence, the energy add, the premium the LNG carrier struck off Oman on Saturday re-inflated. Not because the direction is wrong, but because the input has already moved once and you did not watch it move. The Quad 3 metals expression needs the same treatment: with copper corrected, the complex has no exception left in it.

What would change this is a second, independent confirmation of the same level. The ten-year at 4.745% and the thirty-year at 5.28% have it — verified twice, unchanged. Size to the numbers that survived being checked.

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*Which of this morning's numbers have you seen twice, and which have you only read once?*